

SYLLABUS ITEM 20, PRINTED VERBATIM:

"Aurobindo: Evolution, Involution; Integral Yoga."

|

THREE WORDS, AND NOT ONE OF THEM IS STATABLE ALONE

EVOLUTION = re-emergence of what was FIRST concealed

=> presupposes INVOLUTION

INVOLUTION = self-concealment of an Absolute that is ALREADY

consciousness-force => presupposes a DYNAMIC

Existence-Consciousness-Bliss (saccidānanda)

INTEGRAL YOGA . = conscious participation in the LAST STRETCH of that

evolution => presupposes both of the above

|

AND THE PASSAGE FROM ONE ABSOLUTE TO A GENUINELY MANY WORLD IS EXACTLY
WHAT THE **SUPERMIND** WAS INTRODUCED TO EXPLAIN – a term the printed
clause never mentions and TWO of the eight owned papers ask for directly.

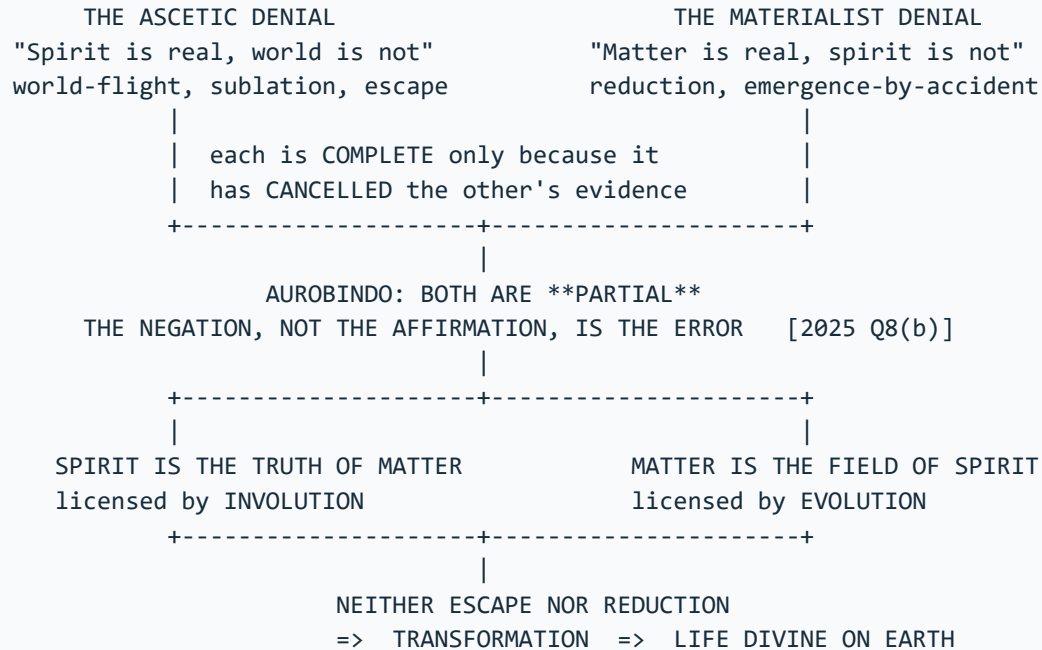
```
+-----+
| CORPUS SIGNAL – 8 primary-owned parts of 112, ONE IN EVERY YEAR 2018-2025 |
| 2018 Q8(c) 15 · 2019 Q8(b) 15 · 2020 Q8(a) 20 · 2021 Q8(a) 20 · |
| 2022 Q8(b) 15 · 2023 Q5(e) 10 · 2024 Q7(c) 15 · 2025 Q8(b) 15 |
| Paper codes: 2018 EGT-P-PHLY · 2019 SDF-U-PHLY · 2020 URC-U-PHLY · |
| 2021 HXS-U-PHLY · 2022 CRNA-F-PHLY · 2023 SKYC-U-PHLY · 2024 PHKM-U-PHL · |
| 2025 SLPM-P-PHL |
+-----+
```

|

WHAT THE EIGHT ACTUALLY DEMAND (six of eight are NOT printed in the clause)
Supermind x2 · triple transformation x2 · gnostic being · psychic being ·
double movement of ascent and descent · divine life as possibility and
inevitability · the ascetic-materialist partiality
INVOLUTION IS NEVER ASKED ALONE – it is always a COMPONENT. Master it
anyway: an unaskable term presupposed by four askable ones is the most
efficient item in the topic.

```
+-----+
| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE |
| Because the Divine first INVOLVED itself down to the Inconscient, Matter can |
| EVOLVE back up to Supermind; therefore the right response to the world is |
| neither escape nor reduction but TRANSFORMATION. |
+-----+
```

- ! TRAP 1: preparing "Evolution, Involution; Integral Yoga" literally is the single most reliable way to UNDER-prepare this clause.
- ! TRAP 2: biography, the freedom movement and Ashram history are CONTEXT ONLY.



THE THREE DENIALS HE MUST ANSWER

BUDDHIST spiritual denial no. 1 – cessation as the final word

ILLUSIONIST spiritual denial no. 2 – the world as falsely-appearing

MATERIALIST the modern denial – Spirit as a late by-product

PRIMARY-SOURCE MAP (using the wrong source-family for a claim is visible)

+-----+		
The Life Divine	metaphysics: Existence-Consciousness-Bliss,	
	Supermind, involution, evolution, ignorance,	
	gnostic being, divine life	
The Synthesis of Yoga	method: Integral Yoga, jñāna-bhakti-karma	
	synthesis, transformation of nature	
Letters on Yoga	fine distinctions: planes, psychic being,	
	ascent, descent, transformation	
Essays on the Gita	spiritual action – a comparative bridge	
The Human Cycle / The Ideal	collective horizon ONLY – bounds it, does not	
of Human Unity	license a political programme	
Savitri / The Mother	corroborative; NEVER the sole proof of a	
	technical doctrine	

Chatterjee & Datta: no substantive Aurobindo chapter. C. D. Sharma: compact survey.
Radhakrishnan Vol. II and Haridas Chaudhuri (The Philosophy of Integralism):
secondary trail.

! TRAP: quoting Savitri as proof of a technical doctrine reads as padding.

! DISCIPLINE: where edition-level verification is unavailable, state the doctrine
WITHOUT quotation marks and name the work-family.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/22: The dynamic Absolute – Existence-Consciousness-Bliss

ULTIMATE REALITY IS ONE (both traditions agree)

|

+-----+

ŚAṂKARA'S ADVAITA (standard reading)	AUROBINDO'S INTEGRAL NON-DUALISM
Ultimate qualityless (nirguṇa) Brahman	Ultimate Existence-Consciousness- Bliss (saccidānanda / sat-cit-ānanda)
Character often read as STATIC, non-relational, world- transcending	Character DYNAMIC, CREATIVE, SELF-MANIFESTING
World ultimately illusion (māyā) / falsely- appearing (mithyā)	World REAL MANIFESTATION of the Divine
Liberation ... knowledge that separateness is unreal	Liberation ... knowledge PLUS transformation of life
Cosmos an empirical concession	Cosmos ontological self- expression

+-----+

|

MEMORISE: "Aurobindo does not deny transcendence; he denies that
TRANSCENDENCE MUST CANCEL IMMANENCE."

WHAT HE ACCEPTS Brahman; the Real as infinite, absolute, self-existent,
conscious, blissful, foundational to all manifestation
WHAT HE REJECTS ILLUSIONISM (māyāvāda) as the FINAL TRUTH about the world
THE REDUCTIO if the world were mere illusion, the long drama of
evolution would be METAPHYSICALLY POINTLESS
ANTI-ILLUSIONISM multiplicity has truth WITHIN unity, not AGAINST unity;
diversity is SELF-ARTICULATION, not a fall

PRESUPPOSITIONS ALREADY IN PLAY (an "examine" question hunts for these)

1. the Absolute must be rich enough to ground BOTH unity and differentiation
2. consciousness must be ONTOLOGICALLY BASIC, not derivative of matter
3. the finite must arise from the Infinite WITHOUT RUPTURE and WITHOUT ILLUSION

! TRAP: "Aurobindo rejects māyā" – he rejects MĀYĀVĀDA AS FINAL; the vocabulary
of divine creative power can be read sympathetically.
! TRAP: "the world is real" does NOT mean "the world is ultimate" – the Divine
is NOT EXHAUSTED by the world.

MATERIALIST DIRECTION

MATTER (basic)

| organisation

v

LIFE (emergent)

|

v

MIND (emergent)

|

v

CONSCIOUSNESS = late by-product

AUROBINDO'S REVERSAL

CONSCIOUSNESS-FORCE (cit-śakti)

| self-concealment

v

MIND

|

v

LIFE

|

v

MATTER = densest self-concealment

|

v

INCONSCIENT = consciousness HIDDEN,
not consciousness ABSENT

```
+-----+
| THE SAME TWO FACTS, TWO READINGS |
| fact 1: mind appears AFTER matter in time |
| fact 2: mind appears in ORGANISED matter |
| materialist ... therefore matter PRODUCES mind |
| Aurobindo ..... therefore matter RELEASES what involution had concealed |
| => the dispute is NOT about the observed sequence but about whether TEMPORAL |
| POSTERIORITY proves ONTOLOGICAL DEPENDENCE |
+-----+
```

CIT is inseparable from CIT-ŚAKTI: consciousness is ALSO FORCE

=> a purely STATIC Absolute could NEITHER INVOLVE NOR EVOLVE

=> this is Aurobindo's objection to a strictly nirguṇa reading of Advaita

=> cit-śakti conducts involution and Nature's emergence of Matter, Life, Mind
and the higher planes – it is a POWER OF THE DIVINE, never a SECOND SUBSTANCE

BUYS ... directionality: involved consciousness makes progressive manifestation
intelligible rather than miraculous

COSTS .. independence: an EMERGENTIST accepts the same data and denies that
novelty requires prior involution

! TRAP: "matter is conscious" in the sense that stones have experiences –
CONCEALMENT is the whole point.

! TRAP: consciousness = mind. MIND IS ONE GRADE, most grades are not mental

! HONEST RESIDUE: "Inconscient consciousness" SOUNDS contradictory and must be explained as complete self-concealment, never merely asserted.

EXISTENCE-CONSCIOUSNESS-BLISS (saccidānanda)

ONE · INFINITE · UNDIVIDED

|

? HOW DOES THE ONE BECOME MANY ?

|

+-----+-----+

ANSWER 1: ILLUSION

the Many are not
really there
(cost: world and
evolution lose
metaphysical value)

ANSWER 2: UNEXPLAINED

LEAP
plurality just
happens
(cost: no explanation
at all)

ANSWER 3: A MEDIATING

PRINCIPLE
= SUPERMIND
(Aurobindo)

|

+-----+-----+

SUPERMIND (vijñāna) = TRUTH-CONSCIOUSNESS = REAL-IDEA	
* knows by IDENTITY, not by representation	
* knowledge and creative force are ONE ACT	
* sees each being IN ITS TRUTH: distinct, never absolutely	
separate; the whole in the part, the part in the whole	
* multiplicity = ORDERED DIFFERENTIATION inside a prior	
truth of unity, NOT fragmentation	

+-----+-----+

MIND vs SUPERMIND

FEATURE	MIND	SUPERMIND
mode of knowledge	indirect, analytical, divisive	direct, integral, truth-bearing
unity and plurality	tends to split and oppose	holds both at once
error	possible and common	TRUTH-NATIVE
relation to concept	abstract representation	REAL-IDEA / creative truth
ontological status	a lower plane	the supramental principle

THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT (a complete 10-marker spine)

1. the Absolute is ONE and INFINITE
2. the world is MANY and FINITE

3. If plurality is REAL, a MEDIATING PRINCIPLE is needed

4. MIND cannot be it – mind already operates BY DIVISION

5. therefore a higher TRUTH-CONSCIOUSNESS is required: the SUPERMIND

NOT THE ABSOLUTE ... it is the FIRST CREATIVE DETERMINATIVE POISE through which
the Absolute manifests the cosmos: supra-cosmic relative to
mind, yet still a DERIVED poise

NOT MIND a different ORDER of consciousness, not a refined faculty

WHAT IT SECURES world-process intelligible · transcendence without world-
negation · plurality without dualism · order without accident

! TRAP (the most punished in the topic): "Supermind = superior intellect".

! TRAP: "Supermind = saccidānanda" throws away the word POSITION in 2019 Q8(b).

! 2019 asks POSITION · 2023 asks ROLE IN EVOLUTION – do not swap the answers.

> NAMING CAUTION: "comprehending / apprehending / projecting" is ONE STANDARD
 > presentation. Naming and numbering VARY. Defend the SUBSTANCE, not the labels.

POISE 1 – COMPREHENDING / TRANSCENDENT

```

+-----+
| ( ..... ) all things held in UNDIVIDED UNITY |
| the many are PRESENT but NOT YET STATIONED as separate centres |
| the Divine is aware of itself as the SOLE EXISTENCE CONTAINING ALL |
+-----+
    
```

|

POISE 2 – APPREHENDING / CREATIVE

```

+-----+
| KNOWER -----> KNOWN |
| a subject-object distinction PROJECTED WITHIN UNITY; the Divine |
| stands back as knower and puts forth the cosmos as known |
| = the poise of the COSMIC SELF / THE LORD (īśvara) |
| distinction appears WITHOUT LOSS OF UNITY |
+-----+
    
```

|

POISE 3 – PROJECTING / INDIVIDUALISING

```

+-----+
| ( • ) ( • ) ( • ) consciousness stands IN each centre and knows |
| FROM that standpoint |
| INDIVIDUALITY IS REAL – but SEPARATENESS HAS NOT YET ARISEN |
+-----+
    
```

|

v

BELOW SUPERMIND: Overmind -> Mind – here a standpoint begins to take
 itself for a SELF-SUFFICIENT WHOLE. THIS, not poise 3, is where
 SEPARATENESS BEGINS.

PAYOFF the One becomes many WITHOUT an unreal illusion AND WITHOUT a
 real fragmentation of the Absolute

CLAIM multiplicity is a REAL SELF-MODIFICATION of consciousness –
 neither a false appearance nor a diminution

PRESUPPOSITION unity can STATION multiplicity within itself without fragmenting;
 deny it and multiplicity is either unreal or a real break

! TRAP: presenting the poises as three STAGES IN TIME.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/22: The three poises – how unity stations multiplicity [2 of 2]

! TRAP: saying separateness begins at poise three – INDIVIDUALITY begins there

! RESIDUE: derived from systematic yogic experience, so a critic may call the scheme stipulative; the reply is that the poises do identifiable EXPLANATORY work, not that they are publicly testable.

INVOLUTION (descent, concealment)	EVOLUTION (ascent, re-emergence)
=====>	<=====

EXISTENCE-CONSCIOUSNESS-BLISS (saccidānanda)

| ULTIMATE REALITY – not one finite plane among planes

v

SUPERMIND (vijñāna) <-- ALONE possesses INTEGRAL truth;

| undivided Truth-Consciousness; NOT mind raised to its maximum

| unity AND multiplicity held by knowledge by identity

v

OVERMIND <-- cosmic gods, vast powers, SEPARATED

| unity FIRST BREAKS into divine aspects

| independently self-existent powers

| LAST PLANE BEFORE IGNORANCE BECOMES POSSIBLE

v

INTUITIVE MIND direct flashes of truth above discursive reason

| (still below supramental totality)

v

ILLUMINED MIND luminous spiritual seeing and inspiration

| (light abundant; integral truth not yet native)

v

HIGHER MIND large ideative spiritual consciousness

| (still works through broad ideas)

v

MIND separative, analytical, representational

| SOURCE OF ORDINARY IGNORANCE AND ERROR

v

LIFE vital force, desire, dynamism, impulse

v

MATTER densest self-concealment of Spirit

| Spirit in SELF-OBLIVION, NOT anti-spiritual

v

INCONSCIENT bottom term: consciousness HIDDEN, not ABSENT

THE YOGA (ASCENT) LADDER, TO BE WRITTEN AS ONE LINE:

Higher Mind -> Illumined Mind -> Intuition -> Overmind -> Supermind

+-----+
| THE DECISIVE DISTINCTION |

OVERMIND DISTRIBUTES one truth into INDEPENDENT POWERS.

SUPERMIND INTEGRATES them in INDIVISIBLE TRUTH.

=> earlier attainments may reach LIBERATION or OVERMENTAL UNIVERSALITY, but
NOT the SUPRAMENTAL TRANSFORMATION of terrestrial nature.

=> the SUPRAMENTAL DESCENT, not an overmental illumination, transforms mind,
life and body.

-----+
WHY THE OVERMIND IS WHERE IGNORANCE BECOMES POSSIBLE

ignorance = DIVISION (panel 9). once one truth stands as many independent
powers, a partial standpoint can be mistaken for a self-sufficient whole.
the Overmind is NOT the CAUSE of ignorance but its CONDITION OF POSSIBILITY.

! TRAP: Overmind treated as a slightly weaker Supermind.

! TRAP: writing the descent order when the question asks for the ascent.

! TRAP: calling Existence-Consciousness-Bliss "the highest plane".

> CAUTION: the exact enumeration and naming VARY. Present a GRADED SCHEME.

GRADE 1 – KNOWLEDGE BY IDENTITY

knower === known – no subject-object gap; Spirit knows itself directly,
because consciousness and existence are NOT DIVIDED there

NATIVE TO: Existence-Consciousness-Bliss and SUPERMIND

| separation appears

GRADE 2 – KNOWLEDGE BY INTIMATE DIRECT CONTACT

knower --(enters)--> known – separation PRESENT but BRIDGED

LEVEL: higher spiritual / intuitive contact

| contact becomes external

GRADE 3 – KNOWLEDGE BY SEPARATIVE DIRECT CONTACT

knower --| gap |--> known – direct contact REMAINS, but from OUTSIDE

LEVEL: sense-perception – direct, yet external

| contact is replaced by signs

GRADE 4 – WHOLLY SEPARATIVE INDIRECT KNOWLEDGE

knower --> [sign | symbol | image | inference | concept] --> ?

it REPRESENTS but does not POSSESS the thing

LEVEL: discursive intellect and empirical representation

<<< ORDINARY HUMAN KNOWING LIVES HERE >>>

THE SEVEN-STEP ARGUMENT

1. ordinary mind is CONSTITUTIVELY SEPARATIVE – it divides and sets subject against object
2. therefore mind can never POSSESS the thing; only represent, classify, compare, infer, image
3. mental knowledge is PARTIAL, MEDIATED and ERROR-LIABLE
4. this epistemic limit is the CORRELATE of the metaphysical ignorance (avidyā) produced by involution
5. SUPERMIND is truth-consciousness (vijñāna / ṛta-cit): it knows BY BEING
6. transformation is therefore NOT more mental knowledge but a CHANGE IN THE MODE OF KNOWING
7. hence Integral Yoga seeks a supramental DESCENT, not a mental ASCENT to refined concepts

NOT MYSTICISM-AS-BLANK-INEFFABILITY

knowledge by identity is SELF-LUMINOUS, DETERMINATE and COMPREHENSIVE:

it knows the many AS the One and the One AS the many. Mind cannot: it either stresses unity by suppressing multiplicity, or stresses multiplicity by

losing unity -> THIS is why Anubhindo can ASSIM the world.

OBJECTIONS -> REPLIES -> RESIDUES

identity collapses	Existence-Consc.-Bliss	the classic
knowledge into mere	contains CIT-ŚAKTI: con-	difficulty about
being	sciousness is self-aware	self-luminous
	FORCE; the demand that	consciousness, also
	knowledge require duality	faced by Advaita's
	is a MENTAL limitation	svayaṃ-prakāśa
empiricist/positivist:	yoga as a REPEATABLE INNER	relocates rather
unverifiable publicly	DISCIPLINE, not dogma	than removes the
		verification problem
"truth-consciousness"	the terms name MODES OF	hard to translate
sounds metaphorical	EXPERIENCE AND BEING inside	into analytic
	the systematic metaphysics	criteria of truth

! TRAP: knowledge by identity glossed as "intuition" – it is knowing BY BEING.

! TRAP: presenting the four grades as a rigid canonical list.

EXISTENCE-CONSCIOUSNESS-BLISS

| SELF-CONCEALMENT begins

↓

SUPERMIND -> OVERMIND -> INTUITIVE -> ILLUMINED -> HIGHER MIND

|

↓

MIND -> LIFE -> MATTER consciousness more veiled at each step

|

↓

INCONSCIENT = the NADIR of concealment

consciousness HIDDEN, not ABSENT

+-----+		
	GUARD 1 – THE PRINCIPLE	
	"Nothing can evolve out of Matter unless it is already involved in it."	
	Matter cannot produce life, mind and spirit if these are ABSOLUTELY ABSENT.	
	=> EVOLUTION PRESUPPOSES INVOLUTION.	
+-----+		
	GUARD 2 – NOT A DATE	
	Involution is ONTOLOGICAL / LOGICAL, not a mythic temporal "fall". It is the	
	CONDITION of manifestation, not an event within it.	
+-----+		
	GUARD 3 – MATTER IS NOT THE ENEMY	
	Matter = Spirit in SELF-OBLIVION, holding the whole divine potential in LATENT	
	form => it can be TRANSFORMED, not merely ESCAPED.	
+-----+		

AGAINST MATERIALISM

+-----+		
matter	basic reality	last term of self-concealed
		Spirit
consciousness	product of matter	latent in matter through
		involution
teleology	absent or secondary	built into existence
evolution	mechanical emergence	unveiling of what is involved
+-----+		

AGAINST SĀMĀKHYA ... matter is NOT an independent unconscious primordial nature
(prakṛti) separate from consciousness; it IS concealed

AGAINST ADVAITA ... the lower world is NOT an illusory appearance to be
sublated; it is a REAL FIELD of Divine manifestation

HONEST WEAK POINT – state it in any "examine" answer
the involution premise is LOAD-BEARING and CLOSE TO QUESTION-BEGGING against
an emergentist. REPLY: emergence of consciousness from wholly inconscient
matter RESTATES rather than explains the mystery, and involution is more
economical IF evolution is directional. RESIDUE: a naturalist can deny
directionality and treat consciousness as emergent.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/22: Ignorance as divided consciousness

INTEGRAL TRUTH (native to SUPERMIND)
the many known AS the One

|

OVERMIND: one truth DISTRIBUTED into multiple
independent powers

|

SEPARATIVE MIND: partial standpoints treated as
SELF-SUFFICIENT WHOLES

|

v

```
+-----+
| THE ORDINARY EGO = FOUR SIMULTANEOUS LOSSES |
| x loses awareness of its TRANSCENDENT SOURCE |
| x loses awareness of COSMIC UNITY             |
| x loses awareness of its SUBLIMINAL DEPTHS    |
| x loses TEMPORAL CONTINUITY                   |
| what is left over, TAKEN AS A CENTRE, *IS* the ego |
+-----+
```

TWO TERMS, ONE PROCESS

INCONSCIENCE the EXTREME term of self-concealment (panel 9's nadir)

MENTAL IGNORANCE ... the ACTIVE DIVIDED MODE in thought, desire and action

STATUS

REAL in its evolutionary effects

NOT an independent anti-divine substance

=> a RESTRICTED OPERATION of consciousness, CAPABLE OF REINTEGRATION

=> therefore liberation is a RE-WIDENING, not a destruction: nothing was
added, so nothing has to be defeated

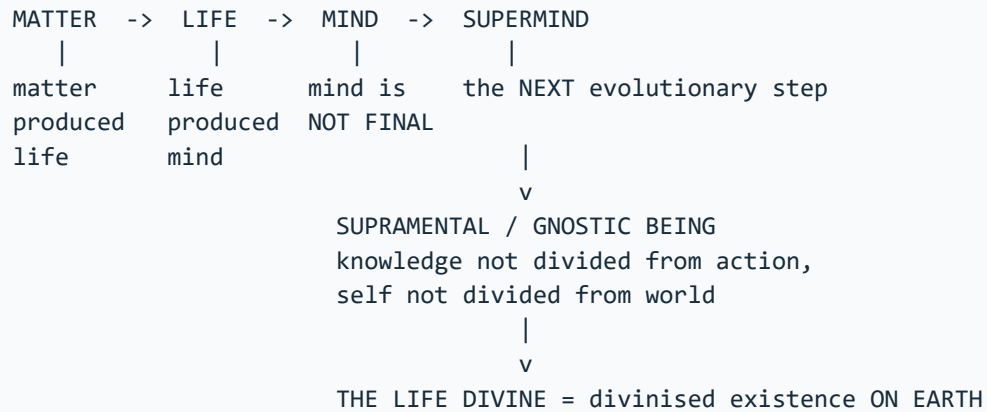
! TRAP: defining ignorance as "absence of knowledge".

! TRAP: making ignorance a SECOND PRINCIPLE opposed to the Divine (that would
make evil ultimate – see panel 19).

! TRAP: calling the ego "unreal". It is a real FUNCTIONAL CONSTRUCTION; what is
false is its claim to be the TRUE BEING.

! RESIDUE: "concealed consciousness" can sound verbally protected from disproof;
Aurobindo answers by graded experience, but public verification is incomplete.

THE BASIC ASCENDING LINE



```

+-----+
| WHERE THE PROCESS CHANGES CHARACTER |
| Matter ... Life ... animal mind | MAN | beyond |
| <-- NATURE EVOLVES UNCONSCIOUSLY->|<- evolution CAN | |
| | BECOME CONSCIOUS->| |
| YOGA = the means by which conscious participation ACCELERATES the hidden |
| evolutionary intention |
+-----+
  
```

"ALREADY INVOLVED" – THE PRECISION PARAGRAPH

- x NOT: future species, institutions or ideas exist in Matter as MINIATURE PREFORMED OBJECTS waiting to be unrolled
- v YES: the POWER or PRINCIPLE of consciousness is involved, and its later manifestation takes GENUINELY NEW ORGANISATION and expression in time
- => CONTINUITY of ontological potential + NOVELTY of evolutionary form
- => emergence is NEITHER creation from absolute absence NOR mechanical unrolling of a fixed visible blueprint
- => an EMERGENTIST can still deny that novelty requires prior involution: that is the exact PHILOSOPHICAL dispute, NOT a disagreement about the observed biological sequence

THE FOUR DIMENSIONS (name them in a 20-marker)

```

+-----+
| transcendent | exceeds every manifested grade| NOT exhausted by cosmic|
| Divine       | while grounding them all | evolution |
+-----+
  
```

conscious	Self-Sakti conducts involution	NOT a second substance
ness-force	and Nature's emergence	beside the Divine
individual	the Self presides; the psychic	cosmic direction does
evolution	being grows and participates	NOT guarantee automatic
	through Yoga	individual attainment
collective	transformed individuals may	NO timetable, political
transformation	alter embodied and social life	blueprint or guaranteed
		species-event
+-----+-----+-----+		

COORDINATION: cosmic evolution supplies the FIELD; individual consent and surrender make conscious transformation POSSIBLE; supramental descent links personal realisation to a TERRESTRIAL horizon.

BOUND: human unity and collective divine life are legitimate CONSEQUENCES; they must NOT DISPLACE Supermind, involution, triple transformation and the double movement in the core answer.

AXIS	DARWINIAN MODEL	AUROBINDONIAN MODEL
REGISTER	empirical science	metaphysical-spiritual philosophy
EXPLANATORY LEVEL	biological process	spiritual-metaphysical process
ENGINE	variation + NATURAL SELECTION	INVOLVED CONSCIOUSNESS PRESSING UPWARD
DIRECTION	no intrinsic cosmic goal	TELEOLOGICAL unfolding
HUMAN STATUS	evolved organism	TRANSITIONAL BEING
END-POINT	none built into theory	supramental / gnostic being

SAFE ANSWER LINE – write this, NOT a refutation claim:

"Aurobindo does not mainly refute biology; he SUPPLEMENTS it with a philosophy of consciousness."

WHAT HE CONCEDES ... biological mechanisms may describe SURFACE PROCESSES

WHAT HE CLAIMS a METAPHYSICAL INTERPRETATION of emergence: WHY consciousness appears and intensifies; a claim about the MEANING of evolution, not a laboratory substitute for it

THE CATEGORY-CONFUSION OBJECTION – and how far the reply goes	
OBJ	biological evolution, psychological growth and metaphysical manifestation are treated as ONE process
RPL	proximate biological mechanism is distinguished from a philosophical account of consciousness and meaning; the levels SUPPLEMENT rather than replace one another
RES	transitions BETWEEN explanatory levels still require ARGUMENT and CANNOT be inferred from biological data
THE UNFALSIFIABILITY OBJECTION	
OBJ	every failure of the descent to appear is explained as incomplete preparation or delayed descent
RPL	coherence, transformative experience and cumulative

phenomenology as non-laboratory evidence

RES	without shared criteria and possible defeaters, the claim
	risks INSULATION from criticism

+-----+

THE REVERSAL AGAINST MATERIALISM: matter is a DERIVATIVE POISE of concealed consciousness => a sustained CRITIQUE OF REDUCTIONISM.

! TRAP: "Aurobindo refutes Darwin."

! TRAP: caricaturing Darwinism as "randomness" – selection is NOT random.

! TRAP: "evolution scientifically proves involution" – emergence is CONSISTENT with his reading; it does not ESTABLISH it.

TERM	STATUS	EVOLVES	FUNCTION
SELF (ātman)	eternal, unborn, immutable Spirit, identical with Existence-Consc.- Bliss	NO	universal Self; never bound or altered by evolution
INDIVIDUAL ETERNAL SELF (jīvātman) = central being	individual Self; a centre/portion of the Divine standing ABOVE manifestation	NO	presides over the individual's WHOLE LINE OF BIRTHS without descending into change
PSYCHIC BEING (caitya puruṣa)	evolving soul- personality formed around the divine spark (caitya)	YES	gathers the ESSENCE of experience through successive lives; comes forward in PSYCHICISATION
EGO / SURFACE PERSONALITY	functional construction of mind-life-body	changes but is not the true being	organises ordinary practical identity by desire, memory, habit, self-assertion
INNER PURUṢA and PRAKṚTI	witness conscious- ness and nature- force at physical, vital, mental levels	puruṣa witness- es; prakṛti acts	Sāṃkhya instrument redeployed PSYCHO- LOGICALLY WITHOUT ultimate dualism

RELATION the psychic being is THE DELEGATE OF THE INDIVIDUAL ETERNAL
SELF IN THE EVOLUTION

TURNING POINT .. its emergence to the front = PSYCHICISATION, replacing
EGO-GUIDANCE with SOUL-GUIDANCE

WHY PSYCHIC TRANSFORMATION MUST COME FIRST – THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT

1. the ordinary person is governed by surface mind, desire, habit and ego
2. these are UNSTABLE and DIVISIVE
3. the psychic being supplies an inner, soul-based principle of DISCERNMENT
and SINCERITY
4. only on this basis can higher spiritual influx be SAFELY ASSIMILATED

~~step 4 is the one candidate only – force entering an ego-governed~~

nature MAGNIFIES THE EGO >>

5. therefore psychic awakening is the FIRST STEP in conscious evolution

PHILOSOPHICAL PAYOFF: holds together (i) the Advaitic truth that the Self is eternally free, (ii) the Sāṃkhya-Yogic truth that individual centres are real, and (iii) the evolutionary truth that something genuinely GROWS. Without the distinction, an evolving soul would CONTRADICT an immutable Self.

OBJECTION: entity-multiplication. REPLY: immutable witness, unevolving centre and evolving experiential soul cannot be ONE term without contradiction.

RESIDUE: the scheme looks STIPULATIVE unless yogic psychology is accepted.

! TRAP: psychic being = Sāṃkhya puruṣa (a STATIC witness).

! TRAP: individual eternal self = psychic being.

! TRAP: the ego is "unreal" – it is PROVISIONAL, and it really functions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/22: The triple transformation [1 of 2]

STAGE 1 – PSYCHIC TRANSFORMATION [what it changes: THE CENTRE]

```
+-----+
| the PSYCHIC BEING (caitya puruṣa) awakens and COMES FORWARD |
| it grows through lives; turns naturally toward truth, beauty, |
| love and the Divine |
| RESULT: the being is REORIENTED FROM EGO TO SOUL |
+-----+
```

```
      | WHY THIS ORDER? only on a true inner centre can
      | higher influx be SAFELY ASSIMILATED
```

v

STAGE 2 – SPIRITUAL TRANSFORMATION [what it changes: THE CONTENTS]

```
+-----+
| the HIGHER SPIRITUAL PLANES DESCEND: |
| Higher Mind -> Illumined Mind -> Intuition -> Overmind |
| progressively spiritualise MIND, LIFE and even BODILY |
| consciousness |
| RESULT: widened consciousness, peace, light, universality, |
| detachment from ego |
| << DANGER: candidates STOP HERE – and lose the question >> |
+-----+
```

```
      | great, but the lower nature is SPIRITUALISED,
      | not yet TRANSFORMED
```

v

STAGE 3 – SUPRAMENTAL TRANSFORMATION [what it changes: THE NATURE]

```
+-----+
| the FINAL and DECISIVE movement: the descent of the SUPERMIND |
| ITSELF |
| transforms the WHOLE NATURE, not merely the inner awareness |
| mind, life AND BODY become INSTRUMENTS OF TRUTH-CONSCIOUSNESS |
| RESULT: THE GNOSTIC BEING |
+-----+
```

WHY EXACTLY THREE, AND IN THIS ORDER – two premises already established

- (i) safe assimilation requires a SOUL-CENTRED base [panel 13]
 - (ii) only INDIVISIBLE truth-consciousness can undo division [panel 7]
- remove either and the sequence is arbitrary; keep both and it is ENTAILED.

STAGE 2 vs STAGE 3 – the examinable distinction

stage 2 works with planes BELOW the Supermind => the truth it brings down is

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/22: The triple transformation [2 of 2]

DISTRIBUTED, stage 3 brings down INTEGRAL truth. The difference is STRUCTURAL,
not a degree of illumination.

RELATION TO INTEGRAL YOGA: triple transformation is the PROCESS; Integral Yoga
is the PARTICIPATION. [2022 Q8(b) is built on exactly this distinction]

! ASKED DIRECTLY: 2018 Q8(c) and 2022 Q8(b) – and NOT printed in the syllabus.

! TRAP: reordering the stages. ! TRAP: omitting the BODY from stage 3.

WHY IT IS CALLED "INTEGRAL" – THREE INTEGRATIONS

+-----+		
(a) INTEGRATION OF PATHS		
does NOT isolate knowledge (jñāna), devotion (bhakti) and		
works (karma) into mutually exclusive routes		
-> ONE many-sided discipline		
(b) INTEGRATION OF THE BEING		
does NOT aim only at inner enlightenment while leaving body,		
life and action unchanged		
-> transformation of MIND + LIFE + BODY		
(c) INTEGRATION OF INDIVIDUAL AND COLLECTIVE DESTINY		
not content with private liberation (mokṣa)		
-> terrestrial, collective, evolutionary transformation		
-> the goal is DIVINE LIFE ON EARTH		
+-----+		

THE PRACTICAL METHOD – THREE ELEMENTS

+-----+		
ASPIRATION	the upward call of the	OPENS the path upward
	being for the Divine	
REJECTION	refusal of lower impulses,	REMOVES resistance
	ego, falsehood, desire,	
	obscurity	
SURRENDER	self-giving to the Divine	ALLOWS the higher
(samarpaṇa)	Mother / Śakti	force to act
+-----+		

NOT merely MORAL disciplines but PSYCHOLOGICAL-SPIRITUAL CONDITIONS
for transformation

THE DECISIVE FACTOR

the Divine Mother / ŚAKTI has a CENTRAL role; surrender is CONSCIOUS
OFFERING, not passivity before fate; the descent of supramental
consciousness is MEDIATED by this Divine Power – NOT the practitioner's
effort alone. [this is also the reply to the HUBRIS objection, panel 20]

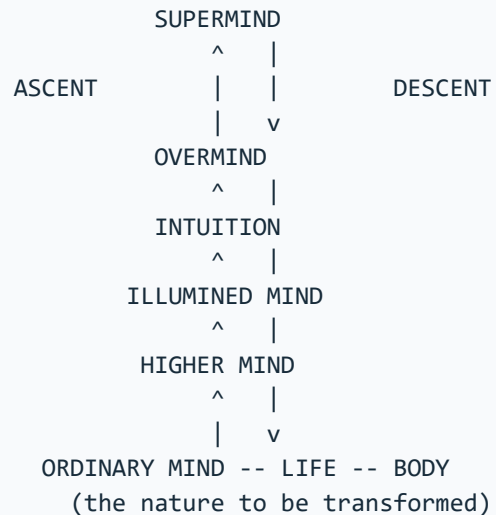
THE REVERSAL OF SPIRITUAL GRAMMAR

many systems: effort -> LIBERATION = completion
Aurobindo : liberation is NECESSARY but PRELIMINARY
-> the larger task is DIVINISATION OF NATURE

Integral Yoga is a FOUNDATION, not a terminus

"ALL LIFE IS YOGA" – work, relation, struggle, body, society and history are fields of conscious transformation, not exclusions from it.

WHAT IT IS NOT: the eight-limbed discipline (aṣṭāṅga-yoga) under a new name. That is a graded ASCETIC discipline of restraint, concentration and cessation; Integral Yoga explicitly REJECTS RENUNCIATION OF LIFE AS THE FINAL IDEAL and is "integral" or FULL (pūrṇa) because it synthesises jñāna, bhakti and karma.



ASCENT – consciousness RISES from ordinary mentality through the higher planes
 order: Higher Mind -> Illumined Mind -> Intuition -> Overmind ->
 Supermind; FREES consciousness from narrow ego-bound mentality

DESCENT – what is realised ABOVE must COME DOWN into the lower nature:
 peace, light, force, wideness, and finally SUPRAMENTAL TRUTH into
 MIND, LIFE and BODY. ONLY THEN is transformation possible.

```

+-----+
| THE TWO FAILURE MODES – this is the ARGUMENT, not decoration |
| ASCENT ALONE .... may give liberation, illumination, transcendence |
|           BUT can leave the LOWER NATURE UNTRANSFORMED |
| DESCENT ALONE ... IMPOSSIBLE – higher consciousness must first be |
|           CONTACTED before it can be brought down |
| => THEREFORE transformation REQUIRES BOTH |
+-----+
  
```

WHO ACTS? the practitioner PREPARES THE INSTRUMENT (aspiration, rejection, surrender); the DESCENT is MEDIATED BY THE DIVINE ŚAKTI. Presenting descent as something the practitioner ACHIEVES converts Integral Yoga into VOLUNTARISM.

RECURS THROUGH THE TRIPLE TRANSFORMATION

- psychic an inward-and-forward turn permitting the FIRST DESCENTS
- spiritual the DESCENT of the planes contacted in ascent

supramental – the DESCENT of the Supramind itself – hence decisive

VERIFIED 2024 WORDING (retain exactly, invent no citation):

"Our Yoga is a double movement of ascent and descent."

EVALUATIVE NOTE: the FIRST failure mode – that transcendence can leave ordinary nature unchanged – is broadly recognisable in the history of mysticism. The SECOND half – that a descent of this kind transforms the BODY – is the contested claim. Distinguish them; "discuss" rewards exactly that.

CONTRAST A – AGAINST PATAÑJALI'S YOGA

metaphysical basis	Sāṃkhya-Yoga DUALISM	integral spiritual monism / dynamic non-dualism
goal	KAIVALYA: isolation of puruṣa from prakṛti	TRANSFORMATION of prakṛti by supramental descent
method	citta-vṛtti-nirodha; the eight-limbed discipline	integral transformation aspiration-rejection-surrender
world-attitude	WITHDRAWAL from entanglement	DIVINISATION of life
end-state	cessation and separation	truth-conscious participation in divine life

COMPACT: Patañjali = release FROM prakṛti · Aurobindo = transformation OF

!! FORBIDDEN IDENTIFICATION – ECHO, NOT IDENTITY !!

ontological status	ṚTAMBHARĀ PRAJÑĀ = a PURIFIED citta-vṛtti, a modification of mental substance at highest clarity	SUPRAMENTAL KNOWLEDGE = NOT a mental modification at all; a DISTINCT PLANE above mind
yogic location	arises with nirvicāra-vaiśāradya; leads to nirbīja samādhi	must DESCEND and be ESTABLISHED in mind, life and body
final destiny	IT TOO MUST CEASE, since kaivalya needs cessation of all vṛtti	NOT to be transcended but EMBODIED as truth-consciousness
goal	kaivalya (isolation)	divine life on earth
metaphysics	dualist: many puruṣas, prakṛti, no relation beyond proximity	integrally non-dual: one Existence-Consc.-Bliss; Matter and Spirit are poles

NEVER WRITE: "Aurobindo adopts Patañjali's ṛtambharā."

SAFE USE: an illustrative ECHO of TRUTH-BEARING character only

CONTRAST B – AGAINST ADVAITA VEDĀNTA

status of world ..	ultimately illusion (māyā) / falsely-appearing (mithyā)
	VS REAL manifestation of Existence-Consciousness-Bliss
goal	knowledge dissolving world-appearance
	VS transformation of earthly life
liberation	realisation of identity
	VS realisation PLUS divinisation
multiplicity	grounded in ignorance (avidyā) / illusion
	VS grounded in SUPERMIND's unity-in-multiplicity

THE ASYMMETRY WORTH STATING: with ADVAITA he SHARES the ontology and differs on cosmology; with PATAÑJALI he differs on BOTH.

'Both Ascetic and materialist are partial in their negation of each other'

READ THE KEY WORD: NEGATION, not affirmation

+-----+			+-----+		
	THE ASCETIC			THE MATERIALIST	
	AFFIRMS Spirit [ok]			AFFIRMS Matter [ok]	
	DENIES Matter [X]			DENIES Spirit [X]	
+-----+			+-----+		

each ABSOLUTES ONE POLE of reality and REJECTS THE OTHER

v

AUROBINDO'S INTEGRAL AFFIRMATION – keep both, drop both denials SPIRIT IS THE TRUTH OF MATTER <-- licensed by INVOLUTION MATTER IS THE FIELD OF SPIRIT'S MANIFESTATION <-- licensed by EVOLUTION

v

NEITHER world-flight NOR flat naturalism

v

DIVINE LIFE ON EARTH (the Life Divine)

v

THE GNOSTIC BEING – the individual form of that life * knowledge is DIRECT and INTEGRAL (knowledge by identity) * action springs from TRUTH-CONSCIOUSNESS, not from ignorance, conflict or ego * the division between INNER and OUTER, INDIVIDUAL and COSMIC, is HEALED IN LIVED CONSCIOUSNESS * body, life and mind are INSTRUMENTS, not obstacles

WHAT THE LIFE DIVINE IS NOT – four negations, each blocking a misreading:

x post-mortem heaven	x private mystical release
x political utopia	x the perfection of ordinary intellect

WHY THIS IS THE TERMINUS, NOT AN APPENDIX: the dynamic Absolute makes manifestation real -> the Supermind makes it intelligible -> involution makes evolution possible -> evolution makes man transitional -> the psychic being

-> Integral Yoga makes it conscious -> THE Gnostic BEING is where the chain ends.

HONEST LIMIT: no publicly established supramental collectivity confirms it;
present the gnostic being as the SYSTEMATIC CULMINATION, not a reported fact.

QUESTION 1 – IS DIVINE LIFE POSSIBLE? [2020 Q8(a), 20 marks] FIVE REASONS

1. Matter is INVOLVED SPIRIT, not an alien anti-spiritual substance
2. life and mind have ALREADY EMERGED from apparently inconscient Matter
 << the STRONGEST reason: the OPPONENT ALREADY CONCEDES IT >>
3. SUPERMIND coordinates unity and multiplicity => not foreign to manifestation
4. psychic and spiritual transformation PREPARE mind, life and body
5. the GNOSTIC BEING names the individual form of the result

QUESTION 2 – IS IT INEVITABLE?

YES, as the INNER DIRECTION of cosmic evolution: mind is TRANSITIONAL and the involved truth-consciousness PRESSES toward fuller manifestation

NO, it does NOT mean: x every present individual must become supramental

 x history follows a FIXED TIMETABLE

 x human effort MECHANICALLY produces the result

BLOCKS AUTOMATISM: the scheme requires ASPIRATION/CALL FROM BELOW *and* SANCTION/DESCENT FROM ABOVE; openness, preparation and surrender remain significant.

CALIBRATION LINE: cosmic teleology is STRONGER than mere possibility but WEAKER than empirical prediction with a specified date and mechanism.

COLLECTIVE: the spread of a NEW PRINCIPLE OF CONSCIOUSNESS through terrestrial life – NOT rule by a self-certified spiritual elite.

STATUS: SPECULATIVE; defended by coherence, prior emergence and disciplined inner evidence.

THE PROBLEM OF EVIL – WHY IT IS SHARPER HERE

EXIT 1 CLOSED: the Advaitic escape (evil belongs to the everyday level, vyāvahārika, and is finally sublated) is unavailable – the world is REAL MANIFESTATION.

EXIT 2 CLOSED: the FREE-WILL DEFENCE is unavailable – suffering rooted in the INCONSCIENT PRECEDES human moral choice.

=> a direct PAPER-II bridge (Philosophy of Religion, Problem of Evil)

THE FIVE-STEP ANSWER

1. evil, falsehood, suffering, death = consequences of INCONSCIENCE produced by involution
2. division -> ego, desire, conflict, error, pain => evil is REAL IN MANIFESTATION but NOT ORIGINAL in Existence-Consciousness-Bliss
3. evil is REAL BUT NOT ULTIMATE – a STAGE of manifestation
4. evil is INSTRUMENTAL and TRANSITIONAL – the Inconscient's resistance makes

the drama of emergence possible

5. therefore evil is TRANSFORMED by supramental descent, not explained away or escaped

THE PAIN / DELIGHT CLAIM – always with its guard

all experience is a modified form of the DELIGHT OF EXISTENCE; PAIN is ĀNANDA received by a consciousness TOO DIVIDED, WEAK OR NARROW to bear it rightly.

GUARD: NOT a denial that pain is experientially real – a metaphysical claim about DISTORTED CONTACT under division. FIT: Ānanda is ultimate; the Inconscient is self-oblivion, not a second anti-divine principle.

SAFE VERDICT: STRONG in linking evil to ignorance and making TRANSFORMATION the answer; WEAK where the cost of cosmic evolution is borne by SUFFERING INDIVIDUALS. NEVER write "fully solved"; write INTEGRATED into the involution-evolution metaphysics.

SET A – SIX STANDARD CRITICISMS (objection -> reply -> residue)

1. VERIFIABILITY OF THE DESCENT

OBJ no public empirical evidence for descent or a gnostic species

RPL the supramental is an evolutionary POSSIBILITY not exhausted by present empirical conditions; mind could not have been "proved" from the standpoint of mere matter BEFORE it emerged

RES blocks PREMATURE CLOSURE; does NOT prove the doctrine

2. PHILOSOPHY OR SPIRITUAL AUTOBIOGRAPHY?

OBJ planes and supramental claims rely on personal yogic experience

RPL much of Indian philosophy accepts yogic perception (yogic pratyakṣa) as a genuine mode of insight; and the system may be assessed by COHERENCE, EXPLANATORY POWER and INTEGRATIVE RANGE

RES discussable, though not experimentally public

3. EMERGENCE FROM THE INCONSCIENT

OBJ if Matter is truly inconscient, emergence is unintelligible

RPL the Inconscient is consciousness HIDDEN, not ABSENT => emergence is MANIFESTATION, not production from sheer non-being

RES the phrase stays paradoxical and must be EXPLAINED

4. ARE THE PLANES ARBITRARY?

OBJ why THESE planes, in THIS order?

RPL derived from SYSTEMATIC SPIRITUAL EXPERIENCE; the order reflects distinct experienced modes; the hierarchy BRIDGES otherwise disconnected levels

RES the warrant remains INTERNAL

5. DOES TELEOLOGY OVERSTATE COSMIC PURPOSE?

OBJ modern science generally avoids intrinsic cosmic purpose

RPL not competing with proximate description; a METAPHYSICAL INTERPRETATION of emergence

RES risks UNFALSIFIABILITY if insulated from every challenge

6. IS WORLD-TRANSFORMATION HUBRISTIC?

OBJ classical traditions stress humility before embodied limits

RPL transformation is NOT egoic self-assertion; it is grounded in SURRENDER to the Divine Force, not human voluntarism

RES the ambition remains large; the reply is doctrinally solid

SET B – FOUR FURTHER OBJECTIONS

DETERMINISM OBJ if Supermind is inevitable, freedom and Yoga are redundant. RPL cosmic direction does not fix each individual's timetable or response; aspiration,

rejection and surrender are modes of PARTICIPATION

RES inevitability vs genuine refusal remains difficult.

ELITISM OBJ a "gnostic race" could legitimate hierarchy or domination. RPL gnostic consciousness is defined by EGO-TRANSCENDENCE, UNITY and SERVICE, not privilege; no one may certify superiority by assertion.

RES private experience gives WEAK PUBLIC SAFEGUARDS against charismatic abuse.

CATEGORY CONFUSION .. OBJ biology, psychology and metaphysics treated as ONE process. RPL levels SUPPLEMENT, not replace.

RES transitions between levels still need ARGUMENT.

UNFALSIFIABILITY OBJ every failure is explained as incomplete preparation or delayed descent. RPL coherence, transformative experience, cumulative phenomenology.

RES without shared criteria and possible DEFEATERS, the claim risks INSULATION from criticism.

THE GRADED VERDICT

STRONG original reconciliation of spiritual non-dualism with evolutionary, this-worldly commitment · answers the charge that Indian philosophy is world-negating · Supermind and its poises give a coherent One->Many account · Integral Yoga is NON-SECTARIAN

WEAK involution premise LOAD-BEARING, near question-begging against emergentism · supramental descent NOT publicly verifiable · theodicy risks INSTRUMENTALISING SUFFERING · the scheme of planes, beings and transformations is ELABORATE and largely dependent on yogic experience

CONTESTED .. whether his readings of Veda, Upaniṣads and Gītā are EXEGESIS or RECONSTRUCTION · whether the system is philosophy, yogic phenomenology, metaphysical theology or a synthesis · the status of claims about BODILY TRANSFORMATION

ONE-LINE VERDICTS BY MARK-WEIGHT

10 ... world-affirming Vedānta; caveat: the supramental future is hard to verify

15 ... a powerful synthesis of Existence-Consciousness-Bliss, evolution and yoga, resting on the controversial premise that what evolves must first be involved

20 ... most original in reconciling non-dual Spirit with real multiplicity and terrestrial transformation; yet premise, theodicy and descent remain philosophically contested

INDIAN POSITIONING – the comparative spine

- ŚAṂKARA Brahman / world as illusion / mediation by māyā-avidyā /
liberation by knowledge / sublation
VS Existence-Consc.-Bliss / REAL manifestation / mediation by
SUPERMIND / liberation PLUS transformation / divinisation
DEBATE POINT: preserves NON-DUALITY while rejecting ILLUSIONISM
- PATAÑJALI puruṣa-prakṛti dualism / kaivalya / restraint, cessation,
isolation / world = bondage-field
VS dynamic spiritual monism / integral transformation / ascent
AND descent / world = transformation-field
- SĀṂKHYA two ultimate realities / independent prakṛti / liberation by
discrimination / prakṛti evolves FOR puruṣa's release
VS one Divine reality in graded manifestation / matter =
concealed Spirit / transformation of nature by Spirit /
evolution = the Divine's self-manifestation
- RĀMĀNUJA world = REAL BODY OF GOD eternally / individual = real dependent
mode / loving service and communion
VS world = real manifestation and BECOMING / individual = real
centre with an EVOLUTIONARY DESTINY / divine life by supramental
transformation
BOTH reject illusionism and affirm world + individual;
DIFFERENCE: God's body ETERNALLY vs a Divine BECOMING with a
SUPRAMENTAL FUTURE
- BUDDHISM denial of a permanent surface self / nirvāṇa, cessation of
ignorance and craving / often read as release from suffering
VS denies EGO but affirms Self, individual eternal self and
psychic being / transformation of life by supramental descent /
world = field for divine manifestation
ACCEPTS the ego-critique; REJECTS nirvāṇa as final IF it means
cessation or world-negation
- THE GĪTĀ major scriptural warrant for spirituality IN ACTION; its
synthesis of jñāna, bhakti and karma supports the claim that
yoga need not be life-renouncing; action without egoic desire
becomes part of the transformation of nature
SAFE LINE: he RADICALISES the Gītā's spirituality of action into
an evolutionary yoga of terrestrial divinisation
- MATERIALISM .. consciousness as a derivative accident of matter
VS matter as a derivative poise of CONCEALED CONSCIOUSNESS
=> a sustained CRITIQUE OF REDUCTIONISM

MYSTICISM often culminates in transcendence BEYOND world and action

VS transcendence ACCEPTED but RETURN, DESCENT and TERRESTRIAL
MANIFESTATION insisted upon => evolutionary, this-world-affirming

CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON – one or two lines MAXIMUM, ALWAYS with the
disanalogy, ALWAYS AFTER the Aurobindo case is complete

BERGSON CONTACT: rejects mechanistic and purely Darwinian accounts;
evolution creative and directional; intuition over analytic
intellect.

DISANALOGY: élan vital is an IMPERSONAL life-impulse with NO
prior involution and NO determinate goal; its creativity is
OPEN-ENDED, whereas Aurobindo's evolution is TELEOLOGICALLY
CLOSED by the recovery of Existence-Consciousness-Bliss;
Bergson's intuition is DURATION-CONSCIOUSNESS, not a supramental
plane; no divine descent, no bodily transformation.
DO NOT ASSERT HISTORICAL INFLUENCE.

HEGEL CONTACT: dynamic Absolutes; the finite is NOT mere illusion but
a moment of the Infinite's self-realisation.

DISANALOGY: Hegel's process is DIALECTICAL and CONCEPTUAL,
through contradiction and sublation (Aufhebung), toward ABSOLUTE
KNOWING as self-conscious THOUGHT; Aurobindo's is SUPRAMENTAL
and EXPERIENTIAL, aiming at divine life in matter and body;
Hegel has no knowledge by identity, no yogic method, no descent,
and would treat bodily divinisation as a CATEGORY ERROR.

TEILHARD CONTACT: the CLOSEST structural parallel – cosmogenesis,
complexity-consciousness, noosphere, Omega Point; both affirm
matter and convergence.

DISANALOGY: Teilhard's framework is CHRISTOLOGICAL and
PERSONALIST; Omega is the cosmic Christ and convergence occurs
at the END of the world-process; Aurobindo's Supermind DESCENDS
INTO and TRANSFORMS terrestrial life INCLUDING THE BODY, WITHIN
manifestation; Teilhard has no involution as prior
self-concealment and no yogic method. Same-period convergence =
PARALLEL DEVELOPMENT, not influence.

NIETZSCHE CONTACT: the human as TRANSITIONAL; self-overcoming beyond the
present human type.

DISANALOGY: the Übermensch is NATURALISTIC, ANTI-METAPHYSICAL
and centred on will and earth WITHOUT Divine descent;
Aurobindo's supramental being arises FROM Truth-Consciousness.

WHITEHEAD CONTACT: process-friendly; rejects a static, world-negating

metaphysics.

DISANALOGY: God and actual occasions do NOT map onto planes of consciousness, involution, supramental descent or bodily transformation.

PLOTINUS CONTACT: procession from the One and return to it resemble involution and evolution.

DISANALOGY: the Plotinian RETURN is an ASCENT AWAY FROM MATTER, the dimmest emanation; Aurobindo's completion is DESCENT INTO Matter and its TRANSFORMATION.

RUBRIC: illustrative only · never a substitute for Aurobindo's own argument · always with the disanalogy · at most one or two lines · writing "Aurobindo is the Indian Bergson/Hegel/Teilhard" WITHOUT the disanalogy is a MARKED WEAKNESS.

PYQ ROUTING 2018-2025 – 8 primary-owned parts of 112, ONE IN EVERY YEAR

YEAR	Q	MARKS	EXACT DEMAND	SESSIONS / PANELS
2018	Q8(c)	15	Evolution + triple transformation + nature of gnostic being	S10+S13+S17 / P11+P14+P18
2019	Q8(b)	15	UNIQUE POSITION of the Supermind in the metaphysical scheme	S4+S5+S6 / P5+P6+P7
2020	Q8(a)	20	'life divine' as POSSIBILITY and INEVITABILITY	S18 / P19
2021	Q8(a)	20	psychic being's awakening and gradual prominence = FIRST STEP; EXPLAIN AND EXAMINE	S12 (+S9) / P13 (+P10)
2022	Q8(b)	15	role of INTEGRAL YOGA in TRIPLE TRANSFORMATION; EXPLAIN AND EVALUATE	S13+S14 / P14+P15
2023	Q5(e)	10	nature and ROLE OF SUPERMIND IN EVOLUTION	S4+S6+S10 / P5+P7+P11
2024	Q7(c)	15	"double movement of ascent and descent"; DISCUSS	S15 (+S14) / P16 (+P15)
2025	Q8(b)	15	'Both Ascetic and materialist are partial in their negation'	S17 (+S8+S10) / P18 (+P9+P11)

FREQUENCIES: Supermind x2 · triple transformation x2 · divine life · psychic being · double movement · ascetic-materialist. INVOLUTION: never asked alone.

DIRECTIVE DECODER

DISCUSS define -> stages -> significance -> ONE contrast
close: "Thus the doctrine is central because..."

EXAMINE claim -> EXPOSE ASSUMPTIONS -> test with objection/reply
close: "It is coherent if its presuppositions are granted."

CRITICALLY EXAMINE . exposition -> STRONGEST objection -> reply -> RESIDUAL
WEAKNESS
close: "Original but not free from the verification/
presupposition problem."

ANALYSE decompose: Existence-Consc.-Bliss, Supermind, involution,
evolution, yoga
close: "The parts form an integral metaphysical chain."

EVALUATE strengths + weaknesses, WEIGHED conclusion

Close: "Strong as synthesis; weak where future descent is

unverifiable."

COMPARE table + at least one DECISIVE DISANALOGY
DISTINGUISH define each separately -> contrast line -> payoff
ELUCIDATE formula -> doctrine -> example -> implication
COMMENT explain -> locate in system -> evaluate
BRING OUT doctrine -> metaphysical, yogic and ethical implications
DO YOU AGREE? partial agreement -> qualification -> calibrated judgement
QUOTED LINE decode WITHOUT inventing a citation -> explain terms ->
link to the system -> examine presupposition/objection

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS (~150 words) L1 define the exact term · L2-4 doctrinal structure in
2-3 technical points · L5-6 the key contrast (Advaita /
Darwin / Patañjali) · L7 one evaluative line
15 MARKS (~250 words) Frame: the problem addressed · Body A: define precisely ·
Body B: inner logic or stages · Body C: contrast with the
nearest rival · Assess: one criticism + one reply ·
Close: Life Divine / transformation
20 MARKS (~350 words) Frame: locate Aurobindo, identify the issue · Body A:
full exposition · Body B: connect to involution and
Integral Yoga · Body C: contrast with Śaṅkara, Darwin or
Patañjali · Assess: criticism and reply · Close: the
significance of transformation of life on earth

MICRO-SKELETONS

SUPERMIND'S UNIQUE POSITION define Truth-Consciousness / Real-Idea -> locate
between the Absolute and lower creation -> unity-
in-multiplicity avoids illusion AND leap -> NOT
the Absolute, NOT Mind -> close on originality
PSYCHIC BEING define the evolving soul-entity -> first awakening
reorients toward the Divine -> enables psychic ->
spiritual -> supramental -> NOT Sāṃkhya puruṣa,
NOT the ego -> first indispensable step
DOUBLE MOVEMENT ascent ladder -> descent into mind-life-body ->
ascent without descent = liberation not
transformation -> descent without ascent
impossible -> both define Integral Yoga
ASCETIC AND MATERIALIST ascetic affirms Spirit denies Matter ->
materialist the reverse -> Spirit is the truth of

~~Matter, Matter the Field of Spirit is neither~~
renunciation nor reductionism is final -> Life
Divine on earth

QUOTATION DISCIPLINE: reproduce VERIFIED PRINTED wording exactly (2024 and 2025 statements); otherwise use ATTRIBUTED DOCTRINAL FORMULATIONS WITHOUT quotation marks – "all life is Yoga" (Synthesis of Yoga) · "man is a transitional being; he is not final" (Life Divine) · "nothing evolves from Matter unless its power was already involved there" (exam-safe paraphrase) · "Supermind is truth-consciousness that holds unity and multiplicity by knowledge by identity" (Life Divine). NEVER invent an edition or page reference.

CLOSING SPINE FOR ANY AUROBINDO ANSWER

involution makes evolution possible -> Supermind makes manifestation intelligible -> the psychic being makes transformation personal -> the triple transformation makes it structured -> Integral Yoga makes it conscious -> the gnostic being and the Life Divine make it terrestrial.

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION: an ambitious world-affirming synthesis that answers the charge of world-negation more completely than any other modern Indian system, and whose open question is not its world-affirmation but its WARRANT.